

CAREX 6273 · FOUNDING FORWARD DEPLOYED ENGINEER · MADISON HYBRID · DIRECT HIRE

THE FOUNDING FDE PLAYBOOK

They need the first Forward Deployed Engineer. I have been that person for twenty years — customer in the room, something that runs on Tuesday, a path the next person can follow.

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Wisconsin. Ready for Madison 3 days onsite as posted.
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19/20

CRISIS ACCOUNTS RECOVERED

8h→1h

DAWN · MEASURED · USED

Founding

PLAYBOOKS FROM A BLANK FLOOR

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Click any line. Use the top strip or the bookmarks panel. This is the operating path I already run — written so the next FDE can run it too.

02 — CAREX 6273 • FINTECH STARTUP PARTNER • MADISON, WI

FOUNDING FORWARD DEPLOYED ENGINEER

Sit with the customer. Find the real constraint. Build, configure, deploy, measure. Leave a playbook. Formal SWE not required — delivery is.

PARTNER WITH CUSTOMERS

IPS / SEAL: embed until the unofficial definition is named. Dawn, Navy Federal, Mercedes, West Bend — I sat with the people who had to run it Tuesday.

DESIGN, BUILD, DEPLOY, SUPPORT

Not a slide. Mappings, Grid/HA, SOAP/REST, agents, bounded MCP. Install-to-go-live. Hypercare default. If they cannot run it, I did not finish.

METRICS BEFORE, MEASURE AFTER

Dawn 8h→1h. Mercedes +200%. West Bend −50%. PepsiCo v9→v10 zero data loss. Local lab: 1.39 → 37.47 tok/s. I write the number first.

REUSABLE SOLUTIONS

Environment Summary. Upgrade Roadmap. Six-class test. TCS kept Mercedes docs. Named skill-up. That is how a founding FDE seeds the function.

FEEDBACK TO PRODUCT

BNY with senior VPs and the CEO in the room. JPM CoE roadmaps. Field → board. Recurring pain becomes the next product, not a one-off.

AMBIGUITY IS THE JOB

No predefined playbook is the posting. I wrote the playbook on the floor for twenty years. Wisconsin. Madison hybrid 3 days as posted.

EPIC AGENT FACTORY — HONEST

Preferred, not required. I have not deployed Epic’s no-code Agent Factory inside an EHR. I have deployed agents, bounded tools, and customer workflows; I have sat in regulated rooms (Navy Federal, Smith & Nephew FDA, Prime Medicare). I will take Agent Factory the same way I took Grid/HA — on the customer’s floor, measured, written down.

FLOOR TO BOARD. SAME FACTS, TWO ROOMS.

The founding FDE is the person who hears the unofficial definition and makes it executable. That is the only work I have done.

- 01

HEAR THE FLOOR
Stand with operators until the real constraint is named. Not the slide. The load, the journal, the SKU, the prior-auth pile, the night workaround from 2011.
- 02

WRANGLE WHAT EXISTS
AS/400 journals, SOAP that never matched the WSDL, messy CSVs, agent skills, local LLMs. I do not wait for a clean ontology. I make the data operable.
- 03

SHIP THE SURFACE
Workflow, automation, agent, lightweight app — whatever the constraint needs. Configure first, build when configure is a lie. If they cannot run it after I drive back to Sand Creek, I did not finish.
- 04

BRIEF THE BOARD
Same facts, two rooms. BNY with senior VPs and CEO Sohaib Abbasi. JPM roadmaps. Loyalty, not a demo. Measure after. Write the playbook so hire two can start on page one.

Madison hybrid. Sand Creek, WI. Three days onsite as posted. The constraint lives with the customer. I go there.

DISCOVER. BUILD. MEASURE. LEAVE.

DISCOVER

Artifact: Environment Summary. Owner, date, unofficial definitions, what is on fire, what already works. Success metric written *before* anyone touches config. You posted that line. It is already the cover of my file.

BUILD / CONFIGURE

Workflows, agent skills, document schemas, integrations, lightweight apps. Agentic tools in daily work: OpenClaw, local Ollama pipeline, bounded MCP. Prototype on the customer’s data, not a sandbox story.

MEASURE AFTER

Dawn 8h→1h. Mercedes +200%. West Bend −50%. Lab: 1.39→37.47 tok/s. Write the after next to the before. If the number did not move, we did not ship value. We shipped theater.

DECOMPOSE

Artifact: Upgrade / build roadmap. Configure vs automate vs build vs simplify. I pick the smallest thing that moves the metric. Formal SWE is not required. Judgment is.

PROVE GO-LIVE

Artifact: Six-class test — operability, same-data, security, performance, 3rd-party, HA/DR. QA twin of production. If it only works when I am in the chair, it is not deployed.

LEAVE THE TEAM

Artifact: Named skill-up. Cheat sheet. Playbook. Hypercare default. TCS kept Mercedes. Farmers named the skill-up in the review. Hire two starts here, not from my Slack.

When it burns. 20 troubled accounts, 19 recovered. Milwaukee insurer: three months dark, closed in two days. Founding FDE still does support. Monitoring, troubleshooting, reliability — that is the job after the demo.

THE STACK I ALREADY RUN. THE STACK I WILL LEARN ON THE FLOOR.

4070 · PRIVATE INFERENCE

TabbyAPI EXL3, Ollama, Open WebUI, Compose + CUDA. Forced offload, VRAM pre-warm, failover. huggingface.co/jpanasuk/tabby-tavern-stack

27x · LOCAL GRID SUITE

Discover, bench decode/prefill, GPU routing, SQLite, CLI + PDF. 1.39 → 37.47 tok/s. Same loop as a customer deploy: measure before claiming.

MCP · DOCKROOT

Agents see Docker/network. They do not get host-root. Hand the agent the boundary, not the box. That is how you put an agent next to a bank or a clinic without becoming the incident.

OPENCLAW + PIPELINE

Systems → architect → validator on local Ollama: structured output, repair retries. Production WhatsApp agents, 10+ skills. Multi-provider routing with cloud failover.

EPIC AGENT FACTORY · ART · EMMIE · PENNY

Epic’s Agent Factory is a no-code builder inside the EHR — previewed HIMSS 2026, wider in 2027. I have not shipped an agent inside Chronicles. I have shipped agents with boundaries, customer workflows with unofficial definitions, and go-lives in regulated rooms. The founding FDE learns the customer’s platform on the customer’s floor. I will treat Agent Factory like Grid/HA: embed, measure, write the standard, leave a team that can shape the next one.

Configure, automate, build, or simplify. You asked for that judgment. I have it. Most “AI projects” need a better process, not another model. I say so in the room.

06 — FIELD RECEIPTS • CONSULTING • IMPLEMENTATION • SUPPORT

VALUE THE CUSTOMER SIGNED. NOT A VIBE.

8h→1h	Dawn Foods — CDC on AS/400 journals. Featured because it got used.	–50%	West Bend — live SOAP/XML quote path. Agent turnaround the next day.
+200%	Mercedes — longest workflows. Playbook stayed with TCS.	7,000h	Micron — 2,080 → 7,000. \$3M extensions. Zero downtime.
\$800k	Toyota — Engine Management go-live. Consultants 5/5.	20+ nodes	MF Global — world-first Grid/HA + DR. Four regions. Virtual team.
\$2.3M+	BNY — Grid/HA with senior VPs and the CEO in the room.	\$10M+	JPMorgan — DW / CoE roadmaps. Field back to product.
3,000h	Navy Federal — architecture through go-live training.	P1	Northwestern Mutual — QA twin of production. Hypercare default.
Phase 2	Farmers — Guidewire XML. Skill-up named in the review.	2 days	Milwaukee — three-month outage closed in two days.

“His knowledge not only of the Informatica suite but also at the operating system level has been truly invaluable.”

DAWN FOODS • CLIENT

“He’s a rock star out at Dawn. The customer loves him and the sales team has been leaning on him hard.”

INFORMATICA IPS • SALES

Also: Kohl’s AIX→commodity · Harvard v9 hypercare · Smith & Nephew FDA · Ace + PepsiCo Big Data · Prime Medicare/MTM · Cargill CFO Award. Retained through 2025 for production rescue.

YOU ARE HIRING THE FIRST ONE. I WRITE LIKE THE SECOND ONE IS WATCHING.

STANDARDS Every engagement opens with a metric and an Environment Summary. Every close has a skill-up name and a QA twin. No tribal knowledge. Hostnames stay off the public copy; the method does not.	REUSABLE KITS Workflow templates, agent skill patterns, integration stubs, test taxonomy. Recurring customer needs become the kit, not another hero week.	INTERNAL TOOLS You asked for automations that make the FDE function cheaper. I already build the tools I wish I had on night one. Then I leave them.
PRODUCT LOOP Field notes back to engineering weekly. If three customers hit the same wall, it is not a services problem. It is the next feature.	HIRING TWO This PDF is the interview. The next FDE should be able to run page 4 without me in Slack. That is how a function is founded.	MADISON Hybrid 3 days onsite, Madison, WI. I live in Sand Creek. Wisconsin. I will be in the room those three days. The customer is why.

WHAT I WILL NOT FAKE

I am not a career Epic analyst. I am not a staff software engineer who has never sat with a customer. I am the closer they send when the platform has to get used — now with agents I measure. Carex’s partner gets the founding motion, not a resume adjective.

08 — THE FIRST HIRE

IF YOU WANT THE PERSON WHO FOUNDS THE FDE FUNCTION — THIS IS THE PATH.

Discovery through deployment, measurement, and ongoing support. Ambiguity is the job. I already treat it that way.

“You have sent one of the best that Informatica has to offer in Jeremy.”

MF GLOBAL • INFRASTRUCTURE

“I trusted that Jeremy would deliver, with quality... exceeded the expectations at someone of his grade level.”

PRIME THERAPEUTICS

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THIS POSTING

Carex Consulting Group · Job 6273
Founding Forward Deployed Engineer
Madison, WI · hybrid 3 days
Direct hire · fintech startup partner
carexconsulting.com/jobs/founding-forward-deployed-engineer-6273

Operating line. Customer satisfaction is worthless. Customer loyalty is priceless. That is the talk I gave on Dawn’s floor. That is how a founding FDE still shows up in Madison.

BACK TO COVER · THE PATH · RECEIPTS